

Slowly, desparatly slowly, the remains of passage debris that encumbered the lower part of the doorway was removed.

With trembling hands I made a tiny breach in the upper left-hand corner. And then, widening the hole a little, I inserted the candle and peered in. The hot air escaping from the chamber caused the flame to flicker, but presently details of the room within emerged from the mist. x Can you see anything?

- decrypt of Kryptos Part 3
(derived from Carter, Howard, *The Tomb of Tutankhamen* (1923))

For fifteen years, KRYPTOS has stood guard to a secret. Contained in the last 97 characters of its encrypted text is a some information, perhaps a vital clue to the whereabouts of the mysterious item buried somewhere on the grounds of the CIA as described in a previously decrypted section. Revealed below is my solution to the puzzle that has garnered the attention of thousands worldwide. Will we find the buried item? Read and see.

The key to solving Part 4 is removal of all the unnecessary letters. The entire design concept of the screen and the system for solving the last of the puzzle is a pun - this is about "Kut Ting" as much as it is about "King Tut."

I. The picture

Start with the last 97 characters:

OBKR

UOXOGHULBSOLIFBBWFLRVQQPRNGKSSO
TWTQSJSSEKZZWATJKLUDIAWINFBNYP
VTTMZFPKWGDZXTJCDIGKUHUAUEKCAR

Remove "KR" and "YP" but not "SOT." Remove "AR" because along with "YAR" that makes "ARRAY" - another word for "matrix." You could say this completes and explains the meaning of "YAR" (but more on other meaning later). Remove this debris (slowly, 'desparatly' slowly, if you must). The backwards spelling of "TOS" is the clue not to remove that. You now have:

OB

UOXOGHULBSOLIFBBWFLRVQQPRNGKSSO
TWTQSJSSEKZZWATJKLUDIAWINFBN
VTTMZFPKWGDZXTJCDIGKUHUAUEKC

Take your 91 characters remaining and form them into a 7x13 "array" as shown:

OBUOXOG
HULBSOL
IFBBWFL
RVQQPRN
GKSSOTW
TQSJSQS
EKZZWAT
JKLUDIA
WINFBNV
TTMZFPK
WGDZXT
JCDIGKU

HUAUEKC

You can see the word "CUT" at the bottom right, but according to the text from Part 3, the "breach" is suppose to be in the upper left. We have to turn the whole thing around to look like this:

CKEUAUH
UKGIDCJ
TXZKDGW
KPFZMTT
VNBFNW
AIDULKJ
TAWZZKE
SSQJSQT
WTOSSKG
NRPQQVR
LFWBBFI
LOSBLUH
GOXOUBO

That's better. With "trembling hands", make a tiny breach (remove the letters "CUT"):

KEUAUH
KGIDCJ
XZKDGW
KPFZMTT
VNBFNW
AIDULKJ
TAWZZKE
SSQJSQT
WTOSSKG
NRPQQVR
LFWBBFI
LOSBLUH
GOXOUBO

Now "widen the hole a little." A "piece" of **KaKE** sounds nice! (Remove K, K and E):

KEU**A**UH
KGIDCJ
XZKDGW
KPFZMTT
VNBFNW
AIDULKJ
TAWZZKE
SSQJSQT
WTOSSKG
NRPQQVR
LFWBBFI
LOSBLUH
GOXOUBO

Hold on to your CANDLE (save it for your KaKE), but the double letters are all "hot air" and we have to remove them. JS (James Sanborn, creator of KRYPTOS) is likely being self-deprecating by saying he's hot air too, so we'll remove that, too.

UAUH
GIDCJ
XZKDGW
KPFZMTT
VNBFNW
AIDULKJ
TAWZZKE
SSQJSQT
WTOSSKG
NRPQQVR
LFWBBFI
LOSBLUH
GOXOUBO

And you are left with a beautiful - what??? -

SATELLITE DISH !

UAUH
GIDCJ
XZKDGW
KPFZM
VNBFNW
AIDULKJ
TAW KE
T
WTO KG
NRP VR
LFW FI
LOSBLUH
GOXOUBO

A SATELLITE DISH ?

Taking the answer as an anagram, a few come to mind --

The first might be "THIS ALL EDITS." Not helpful. If we're done cutting and all we get is this picture, where's whatever is buried?

Another anagram is "I-HELL IS TASTED." If there is an information hell - trying to gain knowledge from useless data, the satellite dish can symbolize those data and the quest to solve KRYPTOS is certainly a taste of "I-HELL." But like the previous anagram, it doesn't resolve our quest.

The correct anagram, I think, is "L SLATE HIDES IT." This is a good one. If "T IS YOUR POSITION" as said in the Morse Code, then a slate a position "L" is certainly believable. But where is Position L?

Let's cut some more 'hot air' by removing all adjacent pairs -- up-down or diagonal -- along with the horizontals we already removed. The second picture underlying the first is already showing through if you know where to look.

UAUH
GIDCJ
XZKDGW
KPFZM
VNBFNW
AIDULKJ
TAW KE
T
WTO KG
NRP VR
LFW FI
LOSBLUH
GOXOUBO

And now we have:

UAUH
GI CJ
X K GW
KP M
VNB NIW
AIDUL J
TAW E
T
WTO KG
NRP VR
FW FI
SBL H
G XO BO

This is better seen with this matrix taken from a spreadsheet:

			U	A	U	H	
			G	I		C	J
	X		K		G	W	
K	P			M			
V	N	B		N	I	W	
I	D	U	L			J	
T	W					E	
						T	
W	T	O			K	G	
N	R	P			V	R	
	F	W			F	I	
		S	B	L	U	H	
G	X	O	U	B	O		

And - wow! - a map of KRYPTOS reveals itself from its hiding place in the 97 characters. Note the screen shaded in green and the water jet - clearly indicated as 'WJET' and shown here in blue. The petrified tree trunk is "W" for wood. The "T" - from "T IS YOUR POSITION" - looking at the code - is at the end of "WJET" and the anagram for "RIGHT" shares that "T" and is shown in green. The other two T's are in the "WRONG" area.

And there we have - plain as day - the location of the buried item. Right under the tile marked "L." Err - one of the tiles marked "L." But which one? Looking carefully, we see that the "L" near or under the sculpture is "DUL" (dull) and at the other location you can form the letters "BLOU" or "below you." The buried item is obviously hidden under the tile marked with the second "L." !

But wait. Our quest may not be over. The "SATELLITE DISH" could mean not "THIS ALL EDITS" but "THIS ALL e DITS" - a clue, perhaps, as to how to fill in the "e's" (Morse dits) in the Morse code section. Solving the Morse Code could reveal that the map is wrong and there is nothing buried. Or perhaps both meanings - "L SLATE HIDES IT" and "THIS ALL e DITS" are correct.

And so the mystery lives on! The only way to know is to solve the Morse Code. And to DIG!

II. Title of the piece (?)

Taking look at the letters we cut out in (I) you will see we have twelve letters:

KR YP AR CUT KKE

The "hot air" letters removed are:

TT SS QQ JS QQ SS BB DD FF KK LL OO UU

Eliminating the doubles from those we have fourteen letters:

TSQJSQSBDFKLOU

All told, we have 26 letters, which is equal to the number of "e" dits in the Morse Code and dovetails nicely with the "This all e dits" interpretation of "SATELLITE DISH" above. In other words, here are the 26 letters that need to be used to complete the Morse Code section (N.B. arriving at a count of 26 "e" dits requires the interpretation of this Morse Code:

- - . - . -

to be read as "DIG e TAL eee" and not as "DIGETALeee.").

Alternatively, we could assume that all of the double letters are "hot air" in accordance with the text and simply drift away.

Including the "out of place" letters from the encrypted text and the tableau, we have:

YAR L KR YP AR CUT KKE

and a "?"

which we can use to form a title for the piece. There are plenty of anagrams to be formed with these letters and the meaning here is certainly subject to debate. In some senses Mr. Sanborn could asking us to interpret his work by choosing the right anagram. I like this idea that you have to get past a lot of hot air to find a useful meaning in an artistic piece, and both this interpretation and the use of the abscissa as "e" dits may be correct.

You could say the remain letters form this:

KRYP CUT ARRAY KKEL

If you could turn the "L" into an "A" the LKKE becomes "KAKE" and you have a place to put the "CANDLE" that we did not use in our above solution.

How to turn the "L" into "A?" Take "CENTRAL INTELLIGENCE AGENCY" and begin with "T" as "YOUR POSITION." Make it through the "R A" (ARRAY) but now you are in "L" (HELL). You need to "step back" into the array and find another way out (i.e., get the message).

But with an "L" turned into an "A" you could also have this:

Y KRY? KLEAR CUT PARK

Which could be interpreted to mean be a criticism of clear cutting of trees where KRYPTOS stands. With this concept, you could say the Central Intelligence Agency took a "step back" when it cut the trees.

If you don't like either of the "stepping back" idea, you could instead say that from the raise letters on the screen you can pull "Y?" and then you balance "AR" on one side with "L" on the other. This suggest that AR=L and you can replace one with the other.

Which gives us:

Y? YLLKRYPARCUTKKE

or

Y? TRY KRACK. KEY: PULL

Which mean to understand the message you have to pull letters from the screen to "krack" the puzzle.

These are the meaning I found here. But you can come up with your own interpretation. That's what art is all about.